



WEBSITE MANAGEMENT GUIDE

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A complete, step-by-step manual for managing the website through the Ghost admin panel — adding posts, pages, stories, events, newsletters, and updating content. No technical knowledge required.

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1 Getting started

Everything on the website is managed from one place: the Ghost admin panel. You log in once and from there you can add or change any content.

Logging in

- 1 Open your web browser and go to your site address followed by `/ghost/` — for example `https://yoursite.com/ghost/`.
- 2 Enter the **email** and **password** for your account.
- 3 You arrive at the **Dashboard**. The dark menu on the left is how you move around.

The left-hand menu

Menu item	What it is for
Dashboard	Overview of the site. You rarely need this for content.
Posts	Most content lives here: success stories, blog posts, events, newsletters, testimonials, activities, and the small "source" posts that feed numbers and tables.
Pages	The fixed pages: Home, About, Programs, Donate, Contact, and so on.
Tags	The labels that decide where a post appears. Usually created automatically as you type them.
Members	Not used for the public website content.
Settings (gear, bottom-left)	Site name, logo, social links, navigation menu, and the theme's site-wide values.

Golden rule: a **Post** is a single item that belongs to a list (one story, one event, one newsletter). A **Page** is a whole standalone page of the site (About, Donate, Contact). When in doubt, almost everything you add day-to-day is a **Post**.

How the website is organised

The site is assembled from three things: **tagged posts**, a few **pages**, and some **site-wide settings**. Understanding the four ideas below makes everything else simple.

1. Tags decide where a post shows up

A post does not appear anywhere until you give it the right **tag**. The tag is the address that tells the website which section to display it in. For example, a post tagged **success-stories** appears in the Success Stories sections; a post tagged **event** appears on the Events page.

The first tag is the category. If a post has several tags, the **first public tag** is treated as its category and is shown as the little label on its card.

2. The same fields are reused everywhere

Every post and page has the same set of fields. This site reuses them in specific ways, so it helps to know what each one becomes.

Field	Where to find it	What it becomes on the site
Title	Top of the editor	The heading, a person's name, or a year
Excerpt	Post settings → Excerpt	The short line on a card — and the event date for events
Feature image	Post settings → Feature image	The card image, photo, or background
Body	The main editing area	The full content; some sections read specific lines or blocks from it
Meta title	Post settings → Meta data	A small label/heading on certain cards
Meta description	Post settings → Meta data	Link text / supporting line on certain cards
Canonical URL	Post settings → Meta data	A link destination on certain cards
Facebook title	Post settings → Facebook card	A link/button URL (hero button, event "Register")
Tags	Post settings → Tags	Which section the post appears in

3. Order is controlled by publish date

Within any section, items are ordered by their **publish date** (newest or oldest, depending on the section). To move an item up or down, change its publish date in **Post settings → Publish date**.

4. Fallback content

Several sections ship with built-in placeholder content. The moment you add your own (the right tagged post or table), your content replaces the placeholder automatically. Remove it and the placeholder returns — the site is never blank.

3 Everyday tasks

The handful of routines below cover almost everything you will do. Learn these once and the page-by-page reference in Section 5 becomes quick to follow.

Create a post (the most common task)

Use this for a success story, a blog post, an event, a testimonial, a programme activity, a newsletter, and the small "source" posts that feed numbers and tables.

- 1 In the left menu, click **Posts**, then the **New post** button (top right).
- 2 Type the **Title** at the top.
- 3 Write or paste the **body** in the large area below the title (story text, photos, a video, a PDF, or a table — depending on the section).
- 4 Open **Post settings** by clicking the **gear icon** at the top right.
- 5 Under **Tags**, type the section's tag and press Enter (e.g. `success-stories`). Create it if it does not exist yet.
- 6 Set the **Excerpt** (the short card line — or the event date, where noted).
- 7 Set the **Feature image** (the card photo).
- 8 Add any extra fields the section needs (Meta data, Facebook title) — see Section 5.
- 9 Click **Publish** (top right) → **Publish** again to confirm.

Create a page and choose its template

Pages already exist for this site. You only do this when building a brand-new page (for example, adding a fourth programme).

- 1 Click **Pages** → **New page**.
- 2 Type the Title.
- 3 Open **Page settings** (gear icon) → **Template** → choose the matching template (see the table in Section 9).
- 4 Open **Page URL** and set the slug (the part of the address after the domain, e.g. `sevadhama`).
- 5 Add the body content the page uses (see Section 5).
- 6 Click **Publish**.

About slugs. The slug is the page's web address. Keep it short, lowercase, and use hyphens instead of spaces

— e.g. `get-involved` . Changing a slug changes the page's link, so set it once and leave it.

Edit existing content

- 1 Go to **Posts** or **Pages** and click the item in the list.
- 2 Make your changes.
- 3 Click **Update** (top right). Changes are live immediately.

Schedule something for later, or set its order

- 1 In **Post settings** → **Publish date**, set the date and time.
- 2 A future date **schedules** the post (it goes live automatically at that time and stays hidden until then).
- 3 To reorder items inside a section, give them earlier or later publish dates relative to each other.

Events are different. Do **not** use a future publish date for an upcoming event, or it will stay hidden. Publish it now and put the event date in the **Excerpt** instead (see Section 7).

Add tags

- 1 Open **Post settings** → **Tags**.
- 2 Type the tag name and press Enter. Use the exact tag from Section 9 — spelling and hyphens matter.
- 3 The **first** tag in the list becomes the post's category label, so order tags with the category first.

Public vs internal tags. A normal tag (e.g. `arogyam-impact`) is what the site looks for. A tag that starts with a hash, like `#hidden` , is internal and will **not** be matched — avoid the hash for section tags.

4 Adding rich content

Inside the body of any post or page you can add more than text. Put your cursor on a new line and click the + button (or type /) to open the content menu.

Image

- 1 On a new line, click + → **Image** and upload the photo.
- 2 To add a caption (used on the Awards page), click "**Type caption...**" under the image and write the text.

Video

- 1 Paste a **YouTube link on its own line** — Ghost turns it into a player automatically; or
- 2 Use + → **Video** to upload a video file from your computer.

On a success story, adding a video makes a **play button** appear on its card. Clicking the play button opens the video in a popup, while "Read story" still opens the full post.

PDF (newsletters and annual reports)

- 1 On a new line, click + → **File** and upload the PDF.
- 2 The card automatically shows the PDF's **first page** as the cover image — you do not need a feature image.

Gallery (home and programme galleries)

- 1 On a new line, click + → **Gallery** and drop in several images.
- 2 A single gallery holds up to 9 images. To add more, add a **second gallery** below the first — all images merge into one gallery on the page.

Table (statistics, sponsorship, legal)

Ghost has no built-in table button, so add one with a **Markdown card** (+ → **Markdown**) using the simple format below.

```
// A markdown table – the first row is the header, then one row per item
| id | name | number |
|----|-----|-----|
| wheelchair | Wheelchairs Distributed | 438 |
| ambulance | Ambulance Services | 403 |
```


Each  separates a column. The header row (and the dashes line under it) are required. Exactly how many columns to use depends on the section — see Section 6.

HTML block (the Team page only)

For laying out team member cards, use + → **HTML** and paste the prepared block. The exact code is in Section 5 under **Team page**.

5 Page-by-page reference

For each page, this section lists every part and exactly what fills it. Unless noted, you add content by creating a post with the listed tag (Section 3) and filling the listed fields.

Home page

Section	How to fill it
Hero slider	Posts tagged hero-slider . Title = big heading, Excerpt = the line below, Feature image = background. Optional Facebook title = the button link.
Who We Are	One post tagged home-about . Title = heading; first line of the body = subtitle; a bullet list in the body = the check-points. The three collage photos come from theme settings (About image 1/2/3).
Focus cards	Posts tagged home-focus . Feature image = background, Title = heading, Excerpt = description, Meta title = pill label, Meta description = link text, Canonical URL = link.
Our Programs	The programme pages tagged home-programs (see "Programmes" in Section 6). Uses each page's Title, Feature image and Excerpt.
Social Impact	Six numbers from theme settings (Section 8). The district/taluk line is fixed.
Testimonials	Posts tagged home-testimonials . Title = name, Excerpt = quote, Feature image = photo.
Success Stories	Posts tagged success-stories (slider, auto-rotates). Add a video in the body for a video story.
Supporters	One post tagged home-partners ; place the logo images in the body.
Upcoming Events	Posts tagged event — shows the soonest upcoming ones (Section 7).
Gallery	One post tagged home-gallery ; place the photos in the body as a Gallery.

About page

Section	How to fill it
Hero subtitle	The page Excerpt .
Media block	Theme setting About media url — a YouTube link shows a video, an image URL shows an image.
Statistics (years / districts / beneficiaries)	Post tagged about-stats — see Section 6.
Vision / Mission / Goal	Post tagged about-purpose — see Section 6.
Core values	Fixed layout.

Our Journey timeline	Posts tagged milestones . Title = year, Excerpt = description, Feature image = photo. A year with no image keeps the previous photo.
Where We Serve map	Theme setting Serve map .

Programs page & the programme pages

The Programs page shows one card per programme — these are the **pages** tagged **home-programs** (Section 6). Each programme has its own page (Sevadhama, Sabalini, Arogyam) built as follows:

Section	How to fill it
About block	From the page body: line 1 = heading, line 2 = paragraph, line 3 onward = a full-width box after the services.
Activities / services	Posts tagged sevadhama-activities / sabalini-activities / arogyam-activities . Title = name, Excerpt = description, Feature image = icon.
Apply / Enquire band	First button — its label comes from Meta title (default "Enquire Now" / "Apply Now") and its link from Canonical URL (default the /enquire/ page). Meta description fills the band paragraph. The second button is a Donate button linking to the Donate page.
Impact numbers	Posts tagged sevadhama-impact / sabalini-impact / arogyam-impact — see Section 6.
Success stories	Posts tagged sevadhama-stories / sabalini-stories / arogyam-stories .
Testimonials	Posts tagged ...-testimonials . Title = name, Excerpt = quote, Feature image = photo.
Video stories	Posts tagged ...-video . Feature image = thumbnail, body = the video + description.
Gallery / Album	Posts tagged ...-album (Title = caption, Feature image = photo), or a Gallery card in the page body.

Impact page

Section	How to fill it
Statistics grid	A 3-column table (id name number) in the page body — see Section 6.
By Programme	Built automatically from the home-programs pages.
Stories behind the numbers	Posts tagged success-stories .

Donate page

Section	How to fill it
Bank account details	The page body.

UPI line	Theme setting Donate UPI id .
QR code	The page Feature image.
Support intro	The page Excerpt.
Sponsorship table	Post tagged <code>donate-sponsorship</code> — see Section 6.
"Donate Online" button	Appears under the QR code only when the page's Meta title (button label) and Canonical URL (donation link) are both filled. Clicking it opens the link in a new tab.
"What your donation funds" cards	Fixed layout.

Contact & Get Involved pages

- **Contact** — address cards, phone, email and the map all come from theme settings (Section 8). The page also includes a contact form.
- **Get Involved** — the Donate / Support / Volunteer cards are fixed (Support and Volunteer link to the Enquire page); the programme-enquiry list is built automatically from the `home-programs` pages.

Stories page

- **Stories grid** — posts tagged `success-stories`, with search and a category filter (category = the post's first tag).
- **Feedback slider** — posts tagged `feedback`. Title = name, Excerpt = quote, Feature image = photo; a video in the body becomes a video testimonial.

Awards page

Add one **Image card** per award in the page body, and write the award name as the image **caption**. They render as a framed two-column grid.

Enquire page

A dedicated enquiry page (template **Enquire**, slug `enquire`) with a fuller form than Contact — name, phone, email, city, "enquiring about", role, and message. The programme **Apply / Enquire** buttons and the Get Involved **Support / Volunteer** buttons point here.

- The supporting text on the left comes from the page body (optional); phone and email come from theme settings.
- You can deep-link to preselect the interest with `?for=`, e.g. `/enquire/?for=Volunteer`.
- Submissions use the same email method as the contact form — see Section 10.

5 Page-by-page reference — Team

The Team page has two parts: leadership cards (from posts) and everyone else (from one HTML block in the page body).

Leadership cards

Create one post per leader, tagged `team-lead`:

- **Feature image** — the photo.
- **Body line 1** — the name. **Line 2** — the position. **Line 3 onward** — a short bio.

Everyone else — one HTML block

- 1 Edit the Team page. On a new line, click + → **HTML** (or type `/html`).
- 2 Paste the block below inside that HTML card and replace the placeholders.
- 3 Use real image addresses (upload a photo anywhere in Ghost, then copy its address). Keep every tag closed.
- 4 Click **Update**.

One group of members

```
<section class="team-grid-section">
  <div class="team-members-grid">
    <div class="team-member-card-vertical">
      <div class="team-member-media">
        
      </div>
      <div class="team-member-body">
        <h3 class="team-card-name">Name</h3>
        <p class="team-card-role">Role</p>
      </div>
    </div>
    <!-- repeat the team-member-card-vertical block for each person -->
  </div>
</section>
```

Several groups with tabs

Add one `team-grid-section` per group, then one `team-category-bar` with a button per group. The Nth button shows the Nth group; the button marked `active` shows first.

```
<section class="team-grid-section"> <!-- group 1 cards --> </section>
<section class="team-grid-section"> <!-- group 2 cards --> </section>

<div class="team-category-bar">
  <div class="team-category-scroll">
    <button type="button" class="team-category-tab active">First Group</button>
    <button type="button" class="team-category-tab">Second Group</button>
```

```
</div>  
</div>
```

6 Updating the numbers & lists

These sections are driven by content you control, so the figures and lists can be updated without any developer. Each keeps its built-in values until you provide your own. Numbers display exactly as typed — commas and a trailing  are kept.

Impact page statistics

In the **Impact page body**, add a Markdown table with three columns: **id**, **name**, **number**. The **id** picks the icon and must match an icon name from Section 9.

```
| id | name | number |
|----|-----|-----|
| search | Identified People with Spinal Cord Injury | 833 |
| wheelchair | Wheelchairs Distributed | 438 |
| blood-units | Units of Blood Collected | 11,399 |
```

Add one row per statistic. Remove the table to return to the built-in set. An unknown **id** simply shows no icon.

Per-programme statistics

Each programme page has its own "by the numbers" section. Create a post with the matching tag and put the same kind of 3-column table (**id** | **name** | **number**) in its body:

Programme	Tag for the stats post
Sevadharma	<code>sevadharma-impact</code>
Sabalini	<code>sabalini-impact</code>
Arogyam	<code>arogyam-impact</code>

About page statistics

Create a post tagged `about-stats` with a two-column table (label, value). The label's wording decides where the value lands:

If the label contains...	It fills...
year	the "Years of service" badge
district	the "Districts served" stat and the "... districts" heading
benefic	the "Beneficiaries reached" stat

```
| Statistic | Value |
|-----|-----|
| Years of service | 21+ |
```

Districts served	7
Beneficiaries reached	833

About page Vision, Mission & Goal

Create a post tagged **about-purpose** and write **three paragraphs** in the body, in this order: Vision, then Mission, then Goal. They fill the three purpose cards.

Donate sponsorship table

Create a post tagged **donate-sponsorship** with a two-column table: what the donation sponsors, and the amount.

Sponsorship Opportunity	Amount
-----	-----
Sponsor a medical kit for one month	₹2,000
Sponsor a wheelchair for a SCI	₹16,000

Legal Status page

Put a two-column table directly in the **Legal page body**: the registration type/label, and its number/value. Each row becomes a card. Leave the body empty to keep the built-in cards.

Registration	Value
-----	-----
Trust Registration (Indian Trust)	B IV-220/2012-13
PAN	AAMTS2926D
80G Tax Exemption	AAMTS2926DF20214

Programmes (add, remove, reorder)

Programmes are **pages** tagged **home-programs**. Add a new page with that tag and it appears automatically on the Home page, the Programs page, the Impact "By Programme" section, and the Get Involved enquiry list — ordered by publish date. Each card links to the page itself, or to the page's **Facebook title** field if you put a URL there. Nothing is fixed at three programmes anymore.

7 Events, newsletters & reports

These are time-based lists. They each have their own listing page, generated from the routes file (Section 8).

Add an event

- 1 **Posts** → **New post**. Type the event title.
- 2 Add the description and any photos in the body. Keep the first paragraph short — only the first few words show on the card.
- 3 Open **Post settings** → **Tags** and add **event**.
- 4 In **Excerpt**, put the **event date** in the format `YYYY-MM-DD` (for example `2026-08-15`). This is what sorts the event into Upcoming / Ongoing / Past.
- 5 In **Facebook title**, paste the registration link (the "Register" button uses it).
- 6 Set a **Feature image** and click **Publish**.

Do not set a future publish date for an upcoming event — Ghost would hide it until that date. Publish it now; the event date lives in the Excerpt. The page reads that date to place the event under Upcoming, Ongoing, or Past.

Past events automatically hide the "Register" button and show a **"Completed"** status instead — on both the events list and the event's own page. You do not need to do anything.

Add a newsletter or annual report

- 1 **Posts** → **New post**. Type the title (e.g. the month and year).
- 2 In the body, click + → **File** and upload the **PDF**. The card automatically shows the PDF's first page as the cover — no feature image needed.
- 3 Add the tag: **newsletter** for monthly newsletters, or **annual-report** for annual reports.
- 4 The publish date determines the year shown in the year filter, and the order. Click **Publish**.

Newsletter subscribe popup

A blue **Subscribe to newsletter** button sits on the Newsletters and Annual Reports pages. Clicking it opens a popup where a visitor enters their email. First-time visitors to the home page also see this popup once (it won't nag returning or already-subscribed visitors).

This is powered by Ghost's built-in Members + email system, which must be switched on once. The one-time setup (Membership, newsletter, and email delivery) is in **Section 10**. Until that is done, the form will show an

error when submitted.

The PDF issues listed on `/newsletters/` are the **archive**. The subscribe popup builds your **email list** so future posts can be emailed out — the two are separate.

Add a blog post

- 1 **Posts** → **New post**. Write the title and the article in the body.
- 2 Add the tag `blog`. The post's first tag is shown as its category.
- 3 Set a Feature image and an Excerpt (the card summary), then **Publish**.

Add a success story (with optional video)

- 1 **Posts** → **New post**. Title = the person's or story's name. Write the story in the body.
- 2 Add the tag `success-stories`. Add a programme tag too (e.g. `sevadharma-stories`) to also show it on that programme page.
- 3 Set a Feature image and a short Excerpt for the card.
- 4 **For a video story**: paste a YouTube link on its own line in the body. A play button appears on the card; it plays in a popup, and "Read story" still opens the full post.
- 5 **Publish**.

8 Settings & navigation

A small number of values are set once and apply across the whole site.

Theme settings

Found under **Settings** → **Design** → **Customize** → **Site-wide**.

Setting	Controls
About image 1 / 2 / 3	The home page "Who We Are" photo collage
About media url	About page media block (a YouTube link or an image URL)
Serve map	About page districts map image
Contact email / phone	Footer and contact page
Contact address (main / southadka / byndoor)	Contact page address cards and footer
Contact map embed url	Map on the contact page
Donate UPI id	UPI line on the donate page
WhatsApp number	Footer WhatsApp icon (digits with country code)
Home stat — identified / rehabilitated / devices / families / health / blood	The six numbers in the home "Social Impact" cards

Ghost general settings

Found under **Settings** → **General**.

Setting	Used for
Title	Site name (footer, page titles)
Description	Footer tagline
Logo	Navbar and footer logo
Publication cover	Hero background when no hero posts exist
Social accounts	Footer social icons — fill any of X, Facebook, LinkedIn, Bluesky, Threads, Mastodon, TikTok, YouTube, Instagram. Unused ones are hidden.

Navigation menu

Built under **Settings** → **Navigation**. Add a label and its link. A label that starts with a dash  becomes a **dropdown item** under the entry above it.

Listing pages (routes file)

Upload `routes.yaml` once under **Settings** → **Labs** → **Routes** → **Upload routes file**. It creates these automatic listing pages. Re-upload it only if the file changes.

Address	Lists posts tagged
/blogs/	blog
/newsletters/	newsletter
/annual-reports/	annual-report
/events/	event

If you see "Something went wrong while loading settings" when uploading routes, it usually means the file is fine but the editor view needs a refresh — reload the admin page and check that `/blogs/` works.

9 Quick reference

Keep this section handy. Tag spelling and hyphens must match exactly.

Tags and where they appear

Tag	Appears in
hero-slider	Home hero slides
home-about	Home "Who We Are"
home-focus	Home focus cards
home-programs	Programme cards (Home, Programs, Impact, Get Involved) – on pages
home-testimonials	Home testimonials
home-partners	Home supporters logos
home-gallery	Home gallery
success-stories	Success stories (Home, Impact, Stories, post sidebar)
feedback	Stories page feedback slider
milestones	About "Our Journey" timeline
about-stats	About statistics (years / districts / beneficiaries)
about-purpose	About Vision / Mission / Goal
sevadharma-activities / sabalini-activities / arogyam-activities	Programme services
sevadharma-impact / sabalini-impact / arogyam-impact	Programme "by the numbers"
sevadharma-stories / sabalini-stories / arogyam-stories	Programme success stories
sevadharma-testimonials / sabalini-testimonials / arogyam-testimonials	Programme testimonials
sevadharma-video / sabalini-video / arogyam-video	Programme video stories
sevadharma-album / sabalini-album / arogyam-album	Programme galleries
donate-sponsorship	Donate sponsorship table
team-lead	Team leadership cards
blog	/blogs/ listing

newsletter	/newsletters/ listing
annual-report	/annual-reports/ listing
event	/events/ listing and home Upcoming Events

Pages and their templates

Page	Template	Page	Template
Home	default	Donate	Donate
About	About	Contact	Contact
Programs	Programs	Get Involved	Get Involved
Sevadhamma	Sevadhamma	Team	Team
Sabalini	Sabalini	Stories	Stories
Arogyam	Arogyam	Awards	Awards
Impact	Impact	Legal Status	Legal
Enquire	Enquire		

Icon names for the statistics tables

Use any of these as the **id** column in an impact table. The icons are **SVG** files in `assets/impact-icons` ; to add a new one, drop a `.svg` there and use its file name (without `.svg`) as the id.

ambulance · blood-donation-camp · blood-units · diabetic-machines · doctors-office · grocery-kit · home-accessibility · hospital-visited · livelihood-cases · medical-assistance · medical-camp · medical-intervention · medical-kit · mobility-aids · panchayats-visited · rehabilitation · rural-women · search · self-employed · serving-health · sewing-machine · solar-inverter · surgical-assistance · taluka-covered · team · walking-stick · wheelchair · women-empowered

Fields used as links

- **Facebook title** — a link URL: the hero slide button and the event "Register" button.
- **Meta title / Meta description / Canonical URL** — the home focus cards; the programme **Apply/Enquire band's first button** (Meta title = label, Canonical URL = link, default `/enquire/`); and the Donate page's **"Donate Online" button** (Meta title = label, Canonical URL = link).
- **Excerpt** — the event date (`YYYY-MM-DD`) for events, and the intro text on the donate page.

Need help? If a section ever looks empty or shows old placeholder content, check three things: the post is **published** (not draft), the **tag** is spelled exactly as listed, and the right **fields** are filled.

10 Forms & email setup

How the Contact form, the Enquire form, and the Newsletter work behind the scenes — and the one-time setup each needs.

Contact form & Enquire form

Both forms use your device's email app. When a visitor presses Submit, their email program (Gmail, Outlook, etc.) opens with a new message pre-filled from the form fields, addressed to your contact email. The visitor then presses Send in their mail app.

Point	Detail
Setup needed	Just the Contact email in theme settings. Nothing else.
Where it goes	Straight to your contact inbox as a normal email.
Good to know	It relies on the visitor having an email app set up. On phones this usually works; on some desktops without a default mail app, the button may do nothing.

Want submissions stored and emailed automatically (no dependence on the visitor's mail app)? Connect a free form service such as **Formspree** or **Web3Forms** — it's a one-line change to each form. Ask your developer to point the forms at the service's address; everything else stays the same.

Newsletter — how it works

- 1 A visitor enters their email in the subscribe popup. Ghost creates a **member** and emails them a **confirmation link** (no password).
- 2 When they click the link, they become a confirmed subscriber to your newsletter.
- 3 To send an issue, you write a normal **Post** and choose "**Publish + Email**" — Ghost emails it to all subscribers. (The PDF issues on the Newsletters page are a separate archive.)

Newsletter — one-time setup in Ghost Admin

- 1 **Settings** → **Membership** → turn **Members on** and allow free sign-ups. Without this, the subscribe popup shows an error.
- 2 **Settings** → **Email newsletter** → create and name your newsletter (e.g. "Sevabharti Newsletter"), and set the sender name and reply-to address.
- 3 **Connect email delivery (Mailgun)**. Ghost sends newsletter emails through **Mailgun**. Create a Mailgun account, verify your sending domain, and paste the Mailgun **API key, domain and region** into Settings → Email newsletter. This is what actually delivers the emails.

4 Optional: brand the sign-up/confirmation experience under **Settings** → **Portal**.

Hosting note. On **Ghost(Pro)**, member sign-ups and confirmation emails work out of the box; you still add Mailgun to send newsletter issues. On **self-hosted** Ghost, configure both the transactional email (SMTP) and Mailgun.

Until Membership + Mailgun are set up, the subscribe button and the first-visit popup will appear but submitting an email will fail. Enable them first, then test with your own email.